Where You Are: Naming What Has Gotten Harder, and What Comes After It

The nine steps of the Family Care Roadmap, with yours marked.

When the care is going all right, it's hard to tell whether there is anything to do, or where you'd begin. There's an order to it, there's time, and you're at the start.

This page shows the whole road, where you are on it, and what comes next.

Phase 1 · Care Assessment

Understand the person, the family, and the situation.

1 **Discover** Current Situation → Concerns & Challenges → Goals & Priorities
You finish with: Family Care Starting Profile

You are here. You're in the middle part of this step, Concerns & Challenges. It's where the family says what has gotten harder, which tasks nobody has quite agreed to, and which conversation to have soon. You finish this part with the family's concerns written down, a follow-up agreed for the ones you chose to discuss, and a way for you to ask for more support.

2 **Assess** Health & Function → Safety & Support → Lifestyle & Preferences
You finish with: Personal Care Baseline and Preferences Profile

3 **Define Needs** Needs & Risks → Care Requirements → Priorities & Recommendations
You finish with: Care Needs Profile and Future Action Roadmap

Phase 2 · Care Planning

Determine what good care should look like and prepare to put it in place.

4 **Explore Options** Care Setting → Provider/Facility Fit → Selection & Decision
You finish with: Preliminary Care Options Research and Decision Plan

5 **Build the Plan** Health & Personal Care → Daily Life & Quality of Life → Monitoring & Response
You finish with: Personal Care Planning File and Future Review Templates

6 **Prepare the Transition** Preparation → Move & Admission → Continuity of Care
You finish with: Transition-Readiness File and Future Handoff Template

Phase 3 · Care Management

Coordinate the plan, review what happens, and prepare the family to take the lead.

7 **Coordinate** People & Responsibilities → Communication & Handoffs → Care-Plan Alignment
You finish with: Care Team, Communication, and Meeting-Readiness Kit

8 **Monitor** Monitor → Identify & Escalate → Review & Adjust
You finish with: Monitoring, Advocacy, and Review-Readiness Kit

9 **Hand Off** Educate → Empower → Support
You finish with: Starter Family Care Playbook and Future Support Plan

What this part produces

A written list of the family's concerns, each in the words of the person who raised it, the follow-up the family agreed on for the ones it chose to discuss, and an agreed way for you to say when you need more support. It is a family's notes, organized. It doesn't judge how the arrangement is going.

It also isn't done once and put away. The National Institute on Aging suggests checking in regularly with the person and the other caregivers, and updating the plan for sharing tasks as circumstances change. [1]

What happens next

This step has three parts: Current Situation, Concerns & Challenges, and Goals & Priorities. The third is about what your husband values and what the family wants to protect, and the concerns you name now are part of what it starts from. After that comes the step called Assess, which looks at health and function, safety and support, and lifestyle and preferences.

Who is involved, by role

- You: your own week on paper, and the concerns you've been carrying.
- Your husband: his own concerns, in his own words.
- Your daughter, the other kids and anyone else who helps: one concern each, and what they have agreed to do.
- His doctor or nurse: any question about his health, and what anything means medically.
- Your care consultant: looks at the whole picture with you and the family, and brings the workload, the disagreements and the tasks that aren't getting done into one conversation.

What this page doesn't promise

How long any step takes, who will be available, or how things turn out. Families move through the steps at different speeds.

Ready for the next step?

You know where this part sits and what comes after it. The care interview is how you finish the step: it walks you through your husband's needs and the help around him area by area, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Family Care Roadmap's own. The advice to check in regularly and update how tasks are shared is the National Institute on Aging's.

1. National Institute on Aging, Sharing Caregiving Responsibilities